

# HOPE Program

## Phase II: Core Program

## Block 2: Interpersonal Relationships and Sexual Self-Regulation

## Homework and Handouts

**Homework: Relationship Analysis (2.2.1)**

*Within this assignment, describe your past and present romantic relationships. More specifically, reflect on and write down what these relationships looked like. The primary purpose of this assignment is to identify relationship patterns from the past, as well as personal strengths and areas for improvement in future relationships.*

1. Describe your past and present "intimate/romantic" relationships. What do these relationships tend to look like? Identify things like how you met, what attracted you to them, how long you were together, how long it was before it got "serious," or how long it was before you became sexual. Additionally, what have your partners been like? Describe their appearances and their personalities. If you are no longer together, how did the relationship end, who ended it and why? What were (are) some of the difficulties you've had in the relationship or the issues that ultimately brought the relationship(s) to an end?

2. List the positive contributions you bring to relationships (e.g., things you do, how you act, specific personality traits, etc.)?

3. List the things you do or don't do that have contributed to relationship problems. These may be

personality traits, attitudes, behaviors, etc.

4. Are there patterns you notice? If so, what are they?

5. What do you plan to do in the future to improve your relationship with an intimate partner?

**Homework: Defining Intimacy (2.3.1)**

Intimacy can be a difficult concept to understand because its meaning is dependent on its context. In its most basic form, intimacy means familiarity or closeness. The more familiar two people are with each other the more intimate they are.

In your own words, please answer the following:

1. Why is intimacy an important issue for you?

2. What do you think a lack of intimacy might keep you from achieving?

3. What changes do you think would happen in your life if you were better at managing intimacy?

**Homework: Monitoring My Intimacy Skills (2.3.2)**

Intimacy can be a difficult concept to understand because its meaning is dependent on its context. In its most basic form, intimacy means familiarity or closeness. The more familiar two people are with each other the more intimate they are. Intimacy is a bond that is based on trust, love, respect, and sharing. Intimacy provides emotional support, comfort, and security, particularly when experiencing stress or some other form of negative affect. Of course, intimacy characterizes not only romantic relationships but friendships as well. Intimacy is also associated with better psychological and physical health.

**Components of Intimacy**

Intimacy requires the development of certain skills and capabilities. These skills are:

Knowledge – Knowing how others feel, think, and respond is an essential part of intimacy. This component of intimacy requires constant maintenance as people's feelings, beliefs and situations change.

Communication - In order to get to know someone, the ability to listen accurately and express oneself clearly is crucial. Communication is required in order to know the rules and limits of a relationship.

Courage - Expressing one's thoughts and feelings to another so that they can get to know you requires making oneself vulnerable. A tendency to be overprotective (secretive) limits intimacy in relationships.

Honesty – Getting to know others and letting others get to know you requires truthfulness and openness.

Respect – Admiring and holding others in high esteem is essential to developing deep intimacy. Without respect intimacy is shallow and frail.

Interest - In order to develop intimacy, one must be interested in the occurrences of his/her partner's life. Otherwise the relationship turns into simple co-existence and lacks depth.

Caring - In addition to interest, one must legitimately be concerned for the other's well-being. Without care, intimacy is short-lived and shallow.

Identify your most intimate relationship. This could be sexual or non-sexual (e.g., sibling or best friend) in nature. Be prepared to share and discuss your answers with the group.

On a scale of 1 to 5 indicate (by circling) how confident you feel in each skill/component in terms of your intimacy with this person. (1 being least confident; 5 being most confident).

Most Significant Relationship: _____

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Knowledge | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Communication | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Courage | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Honesty | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Respect | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Interest | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| Caring | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

**Homework: Intimacy Enhancement Strategies (2.3.3)**

Identify three things that you can do to enhance feelings of intimacy in your relationships. Facilitators are encouraged to ensure that group members have an understanding of some examples (e.g., engaging in shared activities, or improving communication styles). Clients are encouraged to generate these on their own while building on the previous exercise by practicing and implementing at least one strategy. Group discussion should follow to explore the strategies and the experience of implementation.

| Strategies to improve intimacy | Example of Implementation |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |

## Strategies to Combat Loneliness missing (Homework Assignment 2.4.1)

Please identify all of the strategies you have used to combat loneliness. Be prepared to discuss these strategies in group and how effective (or not) they were.

**Homework: Autobiography of Childhood Experiences (2.5.1)**

As you write your childhood autobiography please remember to answer with detailed, informative responses. Take this opportunity to think about your past experiences and increase your personal disclosures with your group members and facilitator(s).

**Early Childhood & Family History:**

1. Where were you born?

_____

_____

2. Where your parents together at the time of your birth?

_____

_____

3. What did your mom do for a living?

_____

_____

4. What did your father do for a living?

_____

_____

5. Do you have any brothers and/or sisters?

_____

_____

a. If so, how many?

_____

_____

b. What is the birth order in your family?

_____

_____

c. Tell the group about your brothers and sisters.

d. How did you get along with your siblings?

6. Were you brought up in a religious home? If so, was religion a significant part of your upbringing?

7. Did you attend Church? If so, how often?

8. What is your ethnicity?

9. Was this an important part of your upbringing?

10. Where did you grow up?

11. If you moved a lot, why? Where did you move to?

a. What was that experience like?

12. Describe what it was like growing up in your home.

13. What were some of the rules in your family? Were there any rules?

14. Who disciplined you when you got into trouble?

a. How were you disciplined?

b. Why were you disciplined?

15. Please describe your earliest childhood memory.

16. Please describe your most significant childhood memory.

17. Do you recall your earliest separations from your parents? What was it like? Did you ever have prolonged separations from your parents?

18. Describe your parent's relationship.

19. Are your parents still together?

a. If not when did they divorce?

b. Do you have step-parents?

c. If yes, how did you get along?

20. How was emotion expressed in your family? (i.e., love, anger, sadness, frustration, disappointment, etc.)

21. How did your parents communicate with you when you were happy and excited? Did they join with you in your enthusiasm? When you were distressed or unhappy as a child, what would happen? Did your caregivers respond differently to you during these emotional times? How?

22. Was there any fighting or abuse in your family? Physical? Sexual? Emotional? Domestic violence? Alcohol or substance abuse? Gambling?

**Teenage Years and School History (13-18):**

1. Describe what your teenage years were like.

2. What did you enjoy about being a teenager?

3. What didn't you enjoy about being a teenager?

4. How did you get along with your family at this time?

5. Who did you get along with best? Why?

6. Who did you get along with least? Why?

7. What did you enjoy about school?

8. What didn't you enjoy about school?

9. Were you ever suspended from school? If so, why?

10. Were you ever expelled from school? If so, why?

11. Describe your friends in school.

12. What activities or sports did you do with your friends?

13. What were your grades in school?

14. Were you ever held back in school?

15. Were your parents involved in your schooling?

16. Was graduating from high school important in your family?

17. Did you graduate from high school? If not, why?

18. Did you attend college or vocational school? Which schools? What majors?

19. What were your future goals when you were an adolescent?

20. What is your most significant memory as an adolescent?

21. How have your childhood/adolescent experiences influenced your relationships with others as an adult? Do you find yourself trying not to behave in certain ways because of what happened to you as a child? Do you have patterns of behaviors that you'd like to alter, but have difficulty changing?

22. What impact do you think your childhood/adolescence has had on your adult life in general, including the ways in which you think of yourself and the ways you relate to your children (if you have children)? What would you like to change about the way you understand yourself and relate to others?

**Homework: What's your attachment style quiz (2.5.2)**

## RELATIONSHIP QUESTIONNAIRE

**Step 1**

**1)** Following are descriptions of four general relationship styles that people often report. Please read each description and CIRCLE the letter corresponding to the style that best describes you or is closest to the way you generally are in your close relationships.

A. It is easy for me to become emotionally close to others. I am comfortable depending on them and having them depend on me. I don't worry about being alone or having others not accept me.

B. I am uncomfortable getting close to others. I want emotionally close relationships, but I find it difficult to trust others completely, or to depend on them. I worry that I will be hurt if I allow myself to become too close to others.

C. I want to be completely emotionally intimate with others, but I often find that others are reluctant to get as close as I would like. I am uncomfortable being without close relationships, but I sometimes worry that others don't value me as much as I value them.

D. I am comfortable without close emotional relationships. It is very important to me to feel independent and self-sufficient, and I prefer not to depend on others or have others depend on me.

**Step** 2

2) Please rate each of the relationship styles above according to the extent to which you think each description corresponds to your general relationship style.

A.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7
(Not at all like me) (Somewhat like me) (Exactly like me)

B.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7
(Not at all like me) (Somewhat like me) (Exactly like me)

C.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7
(Not at all like me) (Somewhat like me) (Exactly like me)

D.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7
(Not at all like me) (Somewhat like me) (Exactly like me)

**Homework: Plans to Improve/Ensure Secure Attachments (2.5.3)**

Identify your plans to ensure more secure attachments as a way to improve intimacy in your life and to achieve greater relationship and life satisfaction. Even if you have secure attachments, there are always ways to improve. Please generate as many possibilities as you can and be prepared to present about these strategies to the group. Many of these examples are very important to overall healthy functioning and considerable attention should be placed on how the individual can achieve these given their current skills and circumstances.

Some ideas might include:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Taking relationships more slowly | Prioritizing personality characteristics rather than physical attributes of potential partners | Not equating sex with love or intimacy |
| Working on issues around trust | Building empathy skills | Becoming more emotionally expressive |
| Showing more interest in the needs and feelings of others | Building feelings of self-confidence and identifying qualities about themselves that they like or things they do well | Looking for reading materials and other resources about healthy relationships (books available to be borrowed from the group facilitator or finding resources in the community) |
| Increase shared interests and activities with partners | Widening their social network | Strengthening non-romantic relationships overall |
| Spending time with family and friends as a couple as well as individually | | |

**Homework: Monitor and Identify Instances of Jealousy (2.6.1)**

First, we would like you to monitor your own jealous emotions over the following week and to record as much as you can about these incidents. Sometimes, this may be easy and other times it may be more difficult to identify when you are feeling jealous. At minimum, identify the circumstance/context of when the emotion was experienced (e.g., having dinner with wife), the intensity of the emotion (1-10 scale), and your behavioral response (e.g., yelled or became passive aggressive). The second component to this assignment includes creating a list of activities or behaviors that you could have done (or did do!) to manage this emotion more effectively. Be prepared to present your assignment to the group on these two components.

1. Record three experiences of jealousy over the next week. These can include anything from high levels of jealousy (e.g., seeing your partner flirt with someone else) to low levels (observing someone else getting praise). If you do not notice anything then recall experiences from prior weeks.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. Write out a list of things that you (or someone else) could do to manage jealousy and suspiciousness.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

## Homework: Strategies for Healthier Boundaries (2.7.1)

### Ten Ways to Build Healthier Boundaries

**1. Name your limits.**

You can't set good boundaries if you're unsure of where you stand. So, identify your physical, emotional, mental and spiritual limits. Consider what you can tolerate and accept and what makes you feel uncomfortable or stressed. Those feelings help us identify what our limits are.

**2. Tune into your feelings.**

Two key feelings have been found in others that are red flags or cues that we're letting go of our boundaries: discomfort and resentment. Think of these feelings on a continuum from one to 10. Six to 10 is in the higher zone and a potential red flag.

If you're at the higher end of this continuum, during an interaction or in a situation, ask yourself, what is causing that? What is it about this interaction, or the person's expectation that is bothering me?

Resentment usually comes from being taken advantage of or not appreciated. It's often a sign that we're pushing ourselves either beyond our own limits because we feel guilty or someone else is imposing their expectations, views or values on us.

**3. Be direct.**

With some people, maintaining healthy boundaries doesn't require a direct and clear-cut dialogue. Usually, this is the case if people are similar in their communication styles, views, personalities and general approach to life.

With others, such as those who have a different personality or cultural background, you'll need to be more direct about your boundaries. Consider the following example: one person feels [that] challenging someone's opinions is a healthy way of communicating, but to another person this feels disrespectful and tense.

There are other times you might need to be direct. For instance, in a romantic relationship, time can become a boundary issue. Partners might need to talk about how much time they need to maintain their sense of self and how much time to spend together.

**4. Give yourself permission.**

Fear, guilt and self-doubt are big potential pitfalls. We might fear the other person's response if we set and enforce our boundaries. We might feel guilty by speaking up or saying no to a family member. Many believe that they should be able to cope with a situation or say yes because they're a good daughter or son, even though they feel drained or taken advantage of. We might wonder if we even

deserve to have boundaries in the first place. Boundaries aren't just a sign of a healthy relationship; they're a sign of self-respect.

**5. Practice self-awareness.**

Again, boundaries are all about honing in on your feelings and honoring them. If you notice yourself slipping and not sustaining your boundaries, ask yourself: What's changed? Consider "What am I doing or [what is] the other person doing?" or "What is the situation eliciting that's making me resentful or stressed?" Then, mull over your options: "What am I going to do about the situation? What do I have control over?"

**6. Consider your past and present.**

How you were raised along with your role in your family can become additional obstacles in setting and preserving boundaries. If you held the role of caretaker, you learned to focus on others, letting yourself be drained emotionally or physically. Ignoring your own needs might have become the norm for you.

Also, think about the people you surround yourself with - Are the relationships reciprocal? Is there a healthy give and take?

Beyond relationships, your environment might be unhealthy, too. For instance, if your workday is eight hours a day, but your co-workers stay at least 10 to 11, there's an implicit expectation to go above and beyond at work. It can be challenging being the only one or one of a few trying to maintain healthy boundaries. Again, this is where tuning into your feelings and needs and honoring them becomes critical.

**7. Make self-care a priority.**

Give yourself permission to put yourself first. When we do this our need and motivation to set boundaries become stronger. Self-care also means recognizing the importance of your feelings and honoring them. These feelings serve as important cues about our wellbeing and about what makes us happy and unhappy.

Putting yourself first also gives you the energy, peace of mind and positive outlook to be more present with others and be there for them. And when we're in a better place, we can be a better wife, mother, husband, co-worker or friend.

**8. Seek support.**

If you're having a hard time with boundaries seek some support, whether that is with a support group, church, counseling, coaching or good friends. With friends or family, you can even make it a priority with each other to practice setting boundaries together and hold each other accountable.

**9. Be assertive.**

Of course, we know that it's not enough to create boundaries; we actually have to follow through. Even though we know intellectually that people aren't mind readers, we still expect others to know what hurts us. Since they don't, it's important to assertively communicate with the other person when they've crossed a boundary.

In a respectful way, let the other person know what in particular is bothersome to you and that you can work together to address it.

**10. Start small.**

Like any new skill, assertively communicating your boundaries takes practice. Start with a small boundary that isn't threatening to you, and then incrementally increase to more challenging boundaries.

Pick at least 2 of the above-mentioned strategies to develop healthier boundaries and attempt to implement these in your daily lives. Over the next week, try to implement these strategies monitor how this went. Using the space below, tell us what worked well? What were you successful with? Where is an area that you struggled? Be prepared to discuss your experience in using these strategies.

**Homework: Sustaining Relationships (2.8.1)**

**Skills in Sustaining Relationships**

1. **Continued meetings and activities together.** Establishing regular activities together is a powerful way to increase intimacy (if compatibility and other factors are right). Having lunch or some other meal together regularly is a good idea. Participating in a sport, exercise, church, a class, studying together, or doing some other activity regularly together is usually an excellent idea if such an opportunity exists. Exceptions might include situations where one person is much better at the activity than the other, where the two people engage in too much competition and/or conflict, or other difficult situations.

2. **Developing conversational intimacy.** Conversational intimacy is essential for a good relationship of any kind, especially a long-lasting, happy romantic relationship.

3. **Recognizing and celebrating similarities.** Being with someone who *understands everything about you at even the deepest levels and loves you for being that way* is a wonderful experience we probably all wish for. To the extent that you can highlight and celebrate these commonalities with your partner through compliments, cards, written statements, symbols (a teddy bear, a gift related to a common interest, etc.), you can "bond" with your partner. In most cases you will probably be similar on those common personal traits, so you can celebrate those similarities in each other. You can create a "mutual admiration society" of at least two people. A compliment *implies* common values. Be open and verbal with your genuine compliments of your partner. People generally give far too few compliments. How do you feel when you receive a genuine compliment? How often have you received too many compliments from others? If you don't give many compliments, start practicing with everyone and watch their reactions. You are giving very meaningful gifts.

4. **Overcoming differences: Increased closeness after successfully resolving a difference.** A time comes in every close relationship when the two partners begin to have disagreements. It could be in the first meeting. *How the two partners cope with conflict is critical to the continuance of the relationship.* If the disagreements are ignored, if there is too much aggression (sarcasm, negative labels, anger, etc.), "game-playing," rejection or hurt feelings, or other dysfunctional approaches to solving the problem, then the relationship will often end at that point. The partners

each feel upset, don't pursue any resolution, and give up. Having a clear discussion of what each is unhappy about and what each wanted is a very constructive way to resolve a conflict that provides valuable information to you both. "I" statements show concern for your partner's feelings and ask him/her to engage in a process of trying to positively resolve differences. If they respond that they are feeling negatively, explore the problem. The good news is that if you successfully resolve a conflict, even a minor one, you will both feel good about your ability to do so together, and your relationship will have crossed a major hurdle. Resolving conflicts builds trust that you each care enough to put the effort and thought into resolving the conflict so you can continue the relationship.

5. **The importance of time and history together and kindness.** Why is it that people who have known each other a long time and had a lot of mutual experiences feel closer over time? It is as simple as that. Time and history together generally add to feelings of closeness, providing they aren't overdone. You don't have to impress or entertain the other person, just spend time with them and treat them in an understanding, respectful, and kind way. If you do that, you will almost always become closer.

**6. Developing more dimensions of the relationship.** Some relationships are more one-dimensional or situational. A tennis partner; a classmate, a work partner, or someone you know at church are all examples of relationships related to one situation. You may find that your conversations are limited to one primary set of topics. To make a relationship more multi-dimensional, talk about more topics, meet your partner in other situations or activities, and do more than just talk together. Have him/her meet your family and friends and visit places of importance to you. Have him/her share important activities or other events important to you. And do the reverse for his/her family, friends, and activities. Of course, your partner must share your interests and be interested in getting to know you better too. If your relationship is too one-dimensional, use these means to increase your closeness and meaningfulness of the relationship. It is a must for developing close romantic relationships. Engage in these new activities at a pace that is comfortable to you both. Check with each other about how you each feel about pursuing new dimensions ahead of time; don't just assume your partner is ready for the next step.

Pick from the above skills directed at sustaining relationships and are to attempt them in the next week. Document each attempt at implementing the skill including the context or situation (e.g., having dinner with spouse), the specific skill that was implemented (attempted new activity,

discussed new topic to make things more multi-dimensional) and the response. The response should include your thoughts and feelings and ideally, how the other person reacted. All group members should participate in questions. If you do not have anybody with which to engage, then please speak about what skills you want to learn and what you might expect from this, including challenges and general outcome.

| Situation (describe the context) | Identify the skill(s) | Response |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

**Homework: Identifying my Love Language (2.8.2)**

Complete the following Love Language Quiz. Be prepared to discuss your result with the group. Were you surprised by the results? Do you agree with them?

**5 Love Languages for Singles**

Below you will see 30 paired statements. Please circle the letter next to the statement that best defines what is most meaningful to you in your relationships. Both statements may (or may not) sound like they fit your situation, but please choose the statement that captures the essence of what is MOST meaningful to you the majority of the time. Allow 10 to 15 minutes to complete the profile. Take it when you are relaxed and try not to rush through it.

1. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    A. someone I love sends me a loving note/text/email for no special reason.

    E. I hug someone I love.

2. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    B. I can spend alone time with someone I love – just us.

    D. someone I love does something practical to help me out.

3. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    C. someone I love gives me a little gift as a token of our love or concern for each other.

    B. I get to spend uninterrupted leisure time with those I love.

4. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    D. someone I love does something unexpected for me to help me with a project.

    E. I can share an innocent touch with someone I love.

5. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    E. someone I love puts their arm around me in public.

    C. someone I love surprises me with a gift.

6. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    B. I'm around someone I love, even if we're not really doing anything.

    E. I can be comfortable holding hands, high-fiving, or putting my arm around someone I love.

7. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    C. I receive a gift from someone I love.

    A. I hear from someone I love that they love me.

8. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

    E. I sit close to someone I love.

    A. I am complimented by someone I love for no apparent reason.

9. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I get the chance to just "hang out" with someone I love.

C. I unexpectedly get small gifts from someone I love.

10. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I hear someone I love tell me, "I'm proud of you."

D. someone I love helps me with a task.

11. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I get to do things with someone I love.

A. I hear supportive words from someone I love.

12. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. someone I love does things for me instead of just talking about doing nice things.

E. I feel connected to someone I love through a hug.

13. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I hear praise from someone I love.

C. someone I love gives me something that shows they were really thinking about me.

14. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I'm able to just be around someone I love.

E. I get a back rub from someone I love.

15. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. someone I love reacts positively to something I've accomplished.

D. someone I love does something for me that I know they don't particularly enjoy.

16. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. I'm able to be in close physical proximity to someone I love.

B. I sense someone I love sowing interest in the things I care about.

17. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. someone I love works on special projects with me that I have to complete.

C. someone I love gives me an exciting gift.

18. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I'm complimented by someone I love on my appearance.

B. someone I love takes the time to listen to me and really understand my feelings.

19. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. I can share a meaningful touch in public with someone I love.

D. someone I love offers to run errands for me.

20. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. Someone I love does something special for me to help me out.

C. I get a gift that someone I love put thought into choosing.

21. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. someone I love doesn't check their phone when we're talking with each other.

D. someone I love goes out of their way to do something that relieves pressure on me.

22. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. I can look forward to a holiday because I'll probably get a gift from someone I love.

A. I hear the words, "I appreciate you" from someone I love.

23. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. someone I love and haven't' seen in a while thinks enough of me to give me a little gift.

D. someone I love takes care of something I'm responsible to do that I feel too stressed to do at the time.

24. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. someone I love doesn't interrupt me when I'm talking.

C. gift giving is an important part of the relationship with someone I love.

25. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. someone I love helps me out when they know I'm already tired.

B. I get to go somewhere while spending time with someone I love.

26. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. someone I love touches my arm or shoulder to show their care or concern.

C. someone I love gives me a little gift that they picked up in the course of their normal day.

27. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. someone I love says something encouraging to me.

B. I get to spend time in a shared activity or hobby with someone I love.

28. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. someone I love surprises me with a small token of their appreciation.

E. I'm touching someone I love frequently to express our friendship.

29. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. someone I love helps me out - especially if I know they're already busy.

A. I hear someone I love tell me that they appreciate me.

30. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. I get a hug from someone I haven't seen in a while.

A. I hear someone I love tell me how much I mean to him/her.

**RESULTS:**

A: _____ Words of Affirmation

B: _____ Quality Time

C: _____ Receiving Gifts

D. _____ Acts of Service

E. _____ Physical Touch

**Which love language received the highest score?**
This is your primary love language. If point totals for two love languages are equal, you are "bilingual" and have two primary love languages. And, if you have a secondary love language, or one that is close in score to your primary love language, this means that both expressions of love are important to you. The highest possible score for any love language is 12.

**Homework: Identifying my Love Language**

Complete the following Love Language Quiz. Be prepared to discuss your result with the group. Were you surprised by the results? Do you agree with them?

**5 Love Languages for Couples**

Below you will see 30 paired statements. Please circle the letter next to the statement that best defines what is most meaningful to you in your relationships. Both statements may (or may not) sound like they fit your situation, but please choose the statement that captures the essence of what is MOST meaningful to you the majority of the time. Allow 10 to 15 minutes to complete the profile. Take it when you are relaxed and try not to rush through it.

1. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I receive a loving note/text/email for no special reason from my loved one.

E. my partner and I hug.

2. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I can spend alone time with my partner – just the two of us.

D. my partner does something practical to help me out.

3. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. my partner gives me a little gift as a token of our love for each other.

B. I get to spend uninterrupted leisure time with my partner.

4. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. my partner unexpectedly does something for me like filling my car or doing the laundry.

E. my partner and I touch.

5. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. my partner puts his/her arm around me when we're in public.

C. my partner surprises me with a gift.

6. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I'm around my partner, even if we're not really doing anything.

E. I hold hands with my partner.

7. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. my partner gives me a gift.

A. I hear "I love you "from my partner.

8. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. I sit lose to my partner.

A. I am complimented by my loved one for no apparent reason.

9. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I get the chance to just "hang out" with my partner.

C. I unexpectedly get small gifts from my partner.

10. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I hear my partner tell me, "I'm proud of you."

D. my partner helps me with a task.

11. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I get to do things with partner.

A. I hear supportive words from my partner.

12. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. my partner does things for me instead of just talking about doing nice things.

E. I feel connected to my partner through a hug.

13. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I hear praise from my partner

C. my partner gives me something that shows he/she was really thinking about me

14. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. I'm able to just be around my partner

E. I get a back rub or massage from my partner

15. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. my partner reacts positively to something I've accomplished.

D. my partner does something for me that I know they don't particularly enjoy.

16. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. my partner and I kiss frequently

B. I sense my partner is showing interest in the things I care about

17. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. my partner works on special projects with me that I have to complete

C. my partner gives me an exciting gift

18. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. I'm complimented by my partner on my appearance

B. my partner takes the time to listen to me and really understand my feelings

19. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. my partner and I share non-sexual touch in public

D. my partner offers to run errands for me.

20. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. my partner does a bit more than his/her normal share of the responsibilities we share (around the house, work-related, etc.)

C. I get a gift that I know my partner put thought into choosing.

21. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. my partner doesn't check his/her phone while we're talking

D. my partner goes out of their way to do something that relieves pressure on me

22. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. I can look forward to a holiday because of a gift I anticipate receiving

A. I hear the words "I appreciate you" from my partner

23. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. my partner brings me a little gift after he/she has been traveling without me

D. my partner takes care of something I'm responsible to do, but I feel too stressed to do it at the time.

24. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

B. .my partner doesn't interrupt me when I'm talking

C. gift giving is an important part of our relationship

25. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. my partner helps me out when he/she knows I'm already tired

B. I get to go somewhere while spending time with my partner

26. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. my partner and I are physically intimate

C. my partner gives me a little gift that he/she picked up in the course of their normal day.

27. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

A. my partner says something encouraging to me

B. I get to spend time in a shared activity or hobby with my partner.

28. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

C. my partner surprises me with a small token of their appreciation

E. my partner and I touch a lot during the normal course of the day

29. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

D. My partner helps me out – especially if I know they're already busy

A. I hear my partner specially tell me, "I appreciate you."

30. *It's more meaningful to me when…*

E. my partner and I embrace after we've been apart for a while

A. I hear my partner say how much I mean to him/her

**RESULTS:**

A: _____ Words of Affirmation

B: _____ Quality Time

C: _____ Receiving Gifts

D. _____ Acts of Service

E. _____ Physical Touch

**Which love language received the highest score?**
This is your primary love language. If point totals for two love languages are equal, you are "bilingual" and have two primary love languages. And, if you have a secondary love language, or one that is close in score to your primary love language, this means that both expressions of love are important to you. The highest possible score for any love language is 12.

**How I Sustain My Relationships (Homework Assignment 2.8.3**

Please identify a relationship that is important to you and answer the following questions. You will be expected to present this to the group.

1. How they show their gentleness in relationships

2. How they show their interest in this person and/or person's interests

3. How they validate this person

4. What type of manner they use when interacting with this person

**Homework: Identifying my Communication Style (2.9.1)**

Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions behind the information. Along with being able to clearly convey a message, one needs to also listen in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood.

There are five main styles of communication that many people find themselves using, whether the style is healthy or not.

1. Passive
    a. Always giving into what others want. Don't want to make waves. Don't express your thoughts or feelings. Afraid to say no. Discounting your own wants and needs.
2. Aggressive
    a. Being demanding, hostile, or rude. Insensitive to the rights of others. Intimidates others into doing what they want. Being disrespectful.
3. Passive-Aggressive
    a. You tell people that they want to hear which avoids conflict. However, you really feel angry inside and you don't follow through on the expectations or requests which results in the other person feeling frustrated, angry, confused, or resentful.
4. Manipulative
    a. Attempt to get what you want by making others feel guilty. Tend to play the role of the victim or the martyr in order to get other people to take responsibility for taking care of your needs.
5. Assertive
    a. Directly, honestly, and appropriately stating what your thoughts, feelings, needs, or wants are. You take responsibility for yourself and are respectful to others. You are an effective listener and problem solver.

In the spaces below, record an example each day of what type of communication pattern you noticed yourself using and provide a description of the context (e.g., where you were, who you were with, what you said, etc.).

| Day of the Week | Type of Communication | Context |
|---|---|---|
| Monday | | |
| Tuesday | | |
| Wednesday | | |
| Thursday | | |
| Friday | | |
| Saturday | | |
| Sunday | | |

**Homework: Monitoring My Communication Skills (2.9.2)**

Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions behind the information. Along with being able to clearly convey a message, one needs to also listen in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood.

Communication is about more than just the words that comes out of one's mouth. Effective communication combines a set of 4 skills:

1. Engaged listening
2. Nonverbal communication
3. Managing stress in the moment
4. Asserting yourself in a respectful way

**Active Listening**

Active listening is a communication technique that encourages the other person to continue speaking. It also enables you to be certain you understand what the other person is saying. It's a way of checking it out. It is referred to as "active" as it lets the other person know that you have really heard them.

**Non-verbal communication**

Less than 10% of what you communicate to someone is interpreted based on what you say. The bulk of the interpretation is based on both how the message is communicated and how you present yourself physically. How you present yourself with regard to body language is very important.

The way a person looks, listens, moves, and reacts to another person tells them more about how s/he is feeling than words alone ever can. Nonverbal communication, or body language, includes facial expressions, body movement and gestures, eye contact, posture, the tone of one's voice, and even one's muscle tension and breathing.

**Keep stress in check**

When things start to get heated in a conversation, people need something quick and immediate to bring down the emotional intensity. By learning to quickly reduce stress in the moment, one

can safely face any strong emotions he or she is experiencing, regulate his or her feelings, and behave appropriately. Here are some ways to keep stress in check and reduce the tension: Recognize when you're becoming stressed; Take a moment to calm down; Bring your senses into the picture; Look for humor in the situation; Be willing to compromise; Agree to disagree.

**Assertiveness**

Direct, assertive expression makes for clear communication and can help boost one's self-esteem and decision-making. Being assertive means expressing one's thoughts, feelings, and needs in an open and honest way, while standing up for him or herself and respecting others. It does NOT mean being hostile, aggressive, or demanding.

Record examples from this last week of interactions that highlight the skills that you have used that were discussed in this module. Examples can include interactions that went well and adhered to these skills or incidents where you may have felt that you fell short, but still tried.

| Day of the Week | Identified Skill Used | Context |
|---|---|---|
| Monday | | |
| Tuesday | | |
| Wednesday | | |
| Thursday | | |
| Friday | | |
| Saturday | | |
| Sunday | | |

**My Conflict Resolution Skills (Homework Assignment 2.10.1)**

Please complete an account of your most notable and recent conflict with someone. This could be, for example, a boss, agent, co-worker, or intimate partner. A description should include who was involved, the context, and a detailed description of what happened. Next, focus on what **you** could have done differently. Although it is highly likely the other individual could have made a number of changes to assist as well, we are not able to control others, only ourselves, so this exercise is focused on what you could have done differently.

**Homework: Applying the SOLVER method (2.10.2)**

Sometimes people feel as though they have had limited opportunities to thoughtfully formulate a course of action based on anticipating and evaluating various outcomes of their decisions. Moreover, they have likely reacted to a problem with a type of "tunnel vision" whereby they have a very narrow frame of reference so that they resorted, almost automatically, to actions they had tried before (e.g., giving up or responding with anger) instead of recognizing resources and solutions in themselves and their environment.

People react to difficult situations or problems with strong emotions like being overwhelmed, frustrated, or stuck. Often, decisions are made in the heat of the moment and such decisions tend not to be wise or effective. The benefit of learning problem solving skills is that it can help people make better decisions that are realistic and useful in both the short and long term.

Recall and write down the circumstances of a situation that recently posed a problem for you. Discuss the way you attempted to solve the problem at the time and how you would potentially approach the same situation **differently** given the SOLVER method.

1. **S**tate your problem:
2. **O**utline your goal/objective:
3. **L**ist your alternatives:
4. **V**isualize the potential consequences of each alternative:
5. **E**valuate the consequences of each alternative:
6. **R**espond and evaluate your chosen solution:

**Homework: Sexual History Autobiography (2.11.1)**

Everyone is unique and has a story to tell with regard to their sexual development. This assignment provides you the opportunity to tell your personal life story in regards to your sexual experiences. A sexual history autobiography is a description of the experiences and messages and resulting attitudes you have regarding sexuality. Although there are no right and wrong answers (this is your life), there are several questions that are relevant that you should respond to in your sexual history autobiography:

- When were you first aware of the sexes' differences?
- Are their gender differences? Why or why not?
- How old were you the first time you learned anything about sex?
- Whom did you learn from?
- How did you feel when you first learned about sex?
- What sexual behaviors did you see between your caregivers? What were your feelings?
- Were you ever personally molested? If so, how did you feel at the time? How do you feel now about the abuse?
- Did you have any sex education classes in school?
- Did you feel free to ask sexual questions in your home? If not, to whom did you go to with your questions?
- Where do our sexual attitudes come from (family, peers, personal experiences, religion/spiritual beliefs, media)?
- What did you personally learn about sex from these sources?
- Did you think it was accurate and did you ever get conflicting information?
- What was your first experience with "making out" or "hooking up" like?
- How old were you when you first had sex with someone? What were your thoughts and feelings?
- How many sexual partners have you had? How many have been one-night stands; prostitutes; married persons; friends with benefits?
- What role has sex played in your life?
- What is the "normal" range of frequency of sexual activity?
- Do any of your sexual fantasies distress you or cause you to be uncomfortable?
- Do you have any sexual problems now? Did you in the past? When have you had problems with erection/orgasm/ejaculation, if ever?

- In your opinion, did any of these above problems lead to sexual acting out?
- What things about your sexual development do you wish were different?

Using the space below, and up to 3 additional pages, please write about your sexual history. Remember, there are no right or wrong answers, only your truth about the sexual experiences in your past.

**Homework: CERTS Model Exercise (2.11.2)**

Describe, in your own words, what each part of the CERTS model means AND define how this would be evident in your current or future relationships:

C:_____

_____

_____

_____

E:_____

_____

_____

_____

R:_____

_____

_____

_____

T:_____

_____

_____

_____

S:_____

_____

_____

_____

**Homework: Meeting our Sexual Needs in Healthy Ways (2.11.3)**

Using what we have discussed, identify in what ways you can improve your sexual thoughts and behaviors. Compare your sexual behavior in the past (up to and including your sexual acting out/offending) with your sexual behavior today. Have you moved closer to a sense of healthy sexuality? In what ways? What areas do you need to work on to ensure that your sexual needs are met in healthier ways in the future? Perhaps this involves communicating your desires in a healthier way with your current partner. Or, asking your partner more about their sexual interests and desires. If you are not currently in a relationship, think back to your most recent relationship and how you would approach the next relationship differently.

**Homework: Pornography's Role in my Life (2.12.1)**

Pornography is understood as any media that promotes unhealthy beliefs about sexuality, exploits sexuality for commercial gain, or is sexually degrading. Pornography is typically degrading towards women but it can also be degrading towards men in that it exploits male sexual myths and widespread beliefs about male sexuality, as introduced in the previous module.

Through this assignment, you will gain an understanding of how portrayals of sex in the media (pornography, commercial media, etc.) influence their attitudes towards male sexuality, sexual partners, women, and children. Moreover, clients should gain an understanding of how pornography may be related to their sexually assaultive behavior.

**PORNOGRAPHY USE QUESTIONNAIRE**

Please answer the following questions about your use of pornography before you were incarcerated.

1) How old were you when you first viewed pornography?
    a. Under 7
    b. Under 12
    c. Under 18
    d. Over 18

2) When you first used pornography did you view it alone or with friends?

_____

_____

3) What pornographic materials did you use?

_____

_____

4) How often did you use pornography?
    a. Once a day
    b. Once a week
    c. Several times a week
    d. Once a month

5) What mood were you in when you used pornography? Please circle all that apply.

a. Restless
b. Angry
c. Bored
d. Happy
e. Sad
f. Sexually aroused

6) Have you ever been dissatisfied with your partner after viewing pornographic material? If so, how?

Physical appearance?

_____

_____

_____

Sexual performance?

_____

_____

_____

7) Have you ever used pornography with violent content? _____

- If so, how did you feel afterwards? Please circle all that apply.

a. Sexually aroused
b. Angry
c. Aggressive
d. Happy
e. Relaxed
f. Sad

How did pornography contribute to your own attitudes and behavior towards women or children? List some of your cognitive distortions and ways that pornography contributed to your distorted thinking

_____

_____

_____

How has pornography impacted areas of your life (e.g., relationships and ability to feel empathy for women or children who are sexually assaulted)?

**Homework: Identifying My Level of Sexual Desire/Urges (2.13.1)**

The purpose of the Sexual Compulsivity Scale-Revised is to identify areas that can be improved to promote sexual satisfaction. Group members should provide their homework to the facilitator and be prepared to discuss their impressions of the questions and how it relates to the definition of the construct discussed in session.

A number of statements that some people have used to describe themselves are given below. Read each statement and then circle the number to show how well you believe the statement describes you.

| | | Not at all like | Slightly like me | Mainly like me | Very much like |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | My sexual appetite has gotten in the way of my relationships. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 2. | My sexual thoughts and behaviors are causing problems in my life. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 3. | My desires to have sex have disrupted my daily life. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 4. | I sometimes fail to meet my commitments and responsibilities because of my sexual behaviors. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 5. | I sometimes get so horny I could lose control. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 6. | I find myself thinking about sex while at work. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 7. | I feel that sexual thoughts and feelings are stronger than I am. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 8. | I have to struggle to control my sexual thoughts and behavior. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |
| 9. | I think about sex more than I would like to. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10. | It has been difficult for me to find sex partners who desire having sex as much as I want to. | **1** | **2** | **3** | **4** |

**Homework: Using Sex to Cope (2.13.2)**

Some people think about sex or engage in sexual activity to manage emotions. The sexual thoughts or behaviors may be either normative or deviant, but the key is that the person relies on sex to self-soothe or mitigate unwelcome feelings of tension, anger, hostility, or anxiety. This is not problematic, in itself. What is problematic is when sex becomes the dominant coping strategy and individuals lack the emotional flexibility to use other strategies should the situation require.

Sexual activity as coping may include either solitary activities (e.g., internet or phone sex, pornography, masturbation) or sexual activity with a partner. In a limited number of cases, sexual thoughts or activity may be a person' only coping strategy; however, in most cases an individual will also have other coping strategies on which they rely.

For most people, negative emotions such as shame, rejection, or anger typically inhibit a sexual response and most people would not find a sexual assault arousing. If negative emotions trigger sexual thoughts and behavior, then it is easy to see how it could lead to sexual offending.

1. Have you ever used sex or masturbation to cope with negative emotional states (anger, sadness, loneliness, etc.) or circumstances? Which ones? Do you find yourself using sex or masturbation to cope more often than other skills?

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. Generate a list of three positive and adaptive coping skills that people can use, instead of sex or masturbation.

_____

_____

_____

_____

3. Of the above-mentioned skills, which one (or ones) can you implement when experiencing negative emotions?

**Insert Satiation (Homework Assignment 2.15.1)**

This exercise is suited to anyone who struggles with deviant interests, urges or attractions. If this is the case for you, make sure you use this technique every time you masturbate. It is recommended that this homework be reviewed during individual therapy. It can also be reviewed in group therapy but that is left the clinical judgement of the facilitator based on the individual and group dynamics.

1. Start masturbating to a fantasy that clearly involves a **consenting adult**. Make sure the person you are fantasizing about has the physical characteristics of an adult (breast development if female, pubic hair, etc.). Be sure to create in your mind a sexual fantasy that is as interesting and sexually exciting as possible!!

2. Continue to masturbate to the adult consenting scenario until orgasm. If you are unable to reach orgasm to this fantasy, switch to whatever fantasy you need to. As soon as you get hard again, change back to an appropriate fantasy. If necessary, switch back and forth until orgasm.

3. **After orgasm**, wait a minute or two and then for **5 to 10** minutes repeat **OUT LOUD** a **deviant fantasy** (eg., sex with a child, rape, exposing yourself in public, etc). There is no need to masturbate while doing this. STOP immediately if you feel yourself getting aroused again!!

After using this technique over an extended period of time, you should begin to notice some decreased arousal to your deviant interests (eg., to children, rape, etc) and an increase in your non-deviant urges (ie., healthy, adult consenting interests). Over time and after you stop using this technique, you may notice a return of your deviant interests. This is to be expected and will most likely happen when you are experiencing negative emotions such as anger, hostility, loneliness or self-pity.

If this does happen, then:

(1) Make use of your new coping strategies to effectively deal with your negative emotions.

(2) Start using satiation again.

**Homework: The Offense Chain (2.16.1)**

Some people are confused by the idea of behavioral chains because, they say, "Nothing led up to my offense. I saw I could do it and I did it. That's all there was to it." Or they say, "It just happened." Or "When she started rubbing my leg I just went with it. I never thought about it before that." What they are saying is that, like most people, they don't examine a freeze frame of all the things that are going on inside them just before they do something. But, as you have seen through treatment, there is always *something* going on inside you.

By placing the events, thoughts, and feelings of a behavior chain in a table, it is easy to see the connections between them. You can construct your own behaivoral chains anytime you take a minute to look inside yourself and see what's going on. In the following exercise, you will begin to look at your sexual offense "under a microscope." The goal of constructing offense chains is to understand what behaviors, thoughts, and feelings led up to your offense(s). Remember that along with your thoughts, feelings, and behaviors, we are also including outside events that affect you. Major events, such as getting laid off from a job, getting a raise, or meeting someone new will of course affect your thoughts, feelings, and behaviors. But even relatively small events can also have important effects, deending on how we think about them.

Starting with your sexual offense, work backward, listing five or more events or behaviors that happened before the first time the offense occurred that led up to the event. Use behaviors or events that contributed to the event or made it more likely to happen. Put these in the left column. Then, in the middle column, write what you thought about each event that happeend or behavior you did as it was happening. Finally, in the right column, write down the feeling you had about each event as it was happening. Use the following questions as a starting point, or answer them on a separate piece of paper after completing the chain on the following page.

1. What is the Life Event that Started the Chain for My Most Recent Offense?
2. How did I feel about this life event? What was I thinking during or right after it happened? What did I do during or right after it happened?
3. After experiencing my life event, what was my goal in that moment and what strategies did I use to achieve this goal?

4. Describe the situation right before the event? What was I thinking and feeling? What did I do?
5. During my sexual offense, what were your goals? What were your plans in the situation? Did you feel in control or out of control and why? What cognitive schemas/distortions were you experiencing?
6. How did you feel right after the offense? How did you feel about the victim?

| Events & Behaviors | Thoughts | Feelings |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

**Homework: The Woodsman (2.16.2)**

After watching the film, answer the following questions. Be prepared to discuss your answers with the group.

1. How did you feel watching film?

2. Who did you identify with in the film and why? Some of the key characters are: Carlos (Benjamin Bratt), Walter (Kevin Bacon), Vickie (Kyra Sedgwick), police Sgt. Lucas (Mos Def). Could you relate to his or her actions?

3. Since 90 percent of children who are sexually abused are abused by someone they know, (Finkelhor, 1994) the film's off-screen stories present a more realistic view of the abuse in our communities than the on-screen story. For example, Walter's sister Annette, has obviously been deeply hurt by Walter, possibly sexually abuse by him, and may fear for the safety of her own daughter. How would you react if someone you loved or someone close to you had been sexually abusive toward a child?

4. What do you think about the other off-screen stories such as Vickie's brothers and their families, Robin's story or Carlos' relationship with his daughter?

5. What reaction did you have to Vickie telling Walter she was sexually abused by her brothers? Were you surprised when she said that she loved her brothers despite their abusive of her?

6. How did Robin's pain connect to Vickie and the film's other victims and survivors of sexual abuse?

7. What could Robin's mother or close family friend have seen in Robin's father and what might they have done before he began to sexually abusing her? Can you imagine noticing Walter's behavior around young girls?

8. What was Walter's cycle of offending? Where was he Low Risk, Medium Risk and High Risk?

9. Can you describe Walter's Risky Emotional States?

10. What choices and decisions could Walter have made differently?

11. Were there people in the film that encouraged or discouraged Walter from re-offending?

12. What was missing in his program of community reintegration?

13. What feedback would you give him as a group member?

14. What other thoughts and feelings did you have?

**Homework: DAM Model**

What causes someone to commit a sex offense? There is not one exact reason known to us what causes a sex offense. Many people have asked, many people try to understand, "what was it exactly?" But the answer is not that easy. There are many variables that must be taken into account when considering why someone engages in harmful, illegal or sexually deviant behaviors. There are different kinds of sex offenses and the explanation for each of them has many, different parts.

Every story has a different combination of reservoir, outlet and dam. Each man's job in treatment is to understand his own and help other offenders understand theirs. It is a challenge to understand and then to make changes.

**THE WATER.** This part of the model and what it represents in each offender is the hardest to explain in a simple way and to understand. What makes you, you? What makes the pressure build, our life experiences influence us?

**THE OUTLET.** In a lake or reservoir that is working right, the outlet is a large pipe or a channel where the water is supposed to drain out in a controlled way so that the pressure doesn't build up too much.

**THE DAM**. In our model of the lake or reservoir, the dam holds back the water so it can't go where it is not supposed to and create a flood and destruction. A good dam is strong enough to do the job under most circumstances. But a dam can be too weak or have cracks or design and construction flaws so that it fails to hold back the water when the pressure rises.

**The combination**. Each offender has his own special **combination** of:

- Size, shape, depth and other features of his **reservoir** (depending on his own personal psychology and sex patterns and history and current life situation);
- usefulness and dependability of his **outlet** (depending on what sources of satisfaction and comfort he has in his life at the time);
- general strength of his **dam** (depending on his ability to control his urges, his attitudes toward hurting others, his use of alcohol and drugs to weaken the structure, and so on.

Using the DAM Model and the space below, explore and explain the circumstances surrounding your sexual offense. What was the water filling up your reservoir? What outlets had you tried or were using, to meet your emotional needs? Which were working, which were not? What are some of the restraints or inhibitions that should stop a potential sex offense? Why did your dam crack under the pressure?